

THE KANJOOS JUGAAD

Stingy and splurging don't have to be mutually exclusive. We tell you how to get things done and save money at the same time, thanks to technology that doesn't cost a bomb.

BY JAYESH SHINDE

The biggest thing to remember in any Kanjoos situation is that the aim to spend money isn't just to show off that you have the latest and greatest things in your house. No, that's not what a jugaadu Kanjoos does. Not if you're a Digit reader, at least.

Here the idea is to make sure that we give you solutions and gadget replacements that will help you gain certain if not all the features that you crave for in any technology deployment in your life – be it at your home or office – without upsetting your bank balance. Why spend unnecessarily if the world of technology's full of ingenuity and cheap alternatives?

So let's take a quick look at some of the ways in which you can save money by investing in smart technology solutions without leaving a hole the depth of the Marianna Trench in your beloved wallet.

SAVE MONEY WITH EFFECTIVE LIGHTING

This is pretty much a no-brainer to begin with. If nothing else, at least change your existing home light fixtures, and try to opt for money saving lighting devices available in the market currently. Incandescent bulbs are largely outdated – we hope. Not only are they highly inefficient but also ridiculously expensive now. Using them makes absolutely no sense in the 21st century. What's more, the much awaited replacement of the incandescent light bulb – CFL technology is also not all that great. Sure it helps you save money in comparison to the incandescent light bulb, but there are products available

in the market that will let you save even more money. Yes, I'm talking about LED lighting solutions. Available as large and tiny bulbs, LEDs not only last longer than both incandescent and CFL bulbs combined but they are capable of operating at very low power levels without compromising on luminance levels. On an average, LED bulbs last 11 years of continuous operation or over 20 years of 50% operation (daily usage of 12 hours). It's also very efficient, transmitting up to 90% of the energy it consumes to pro-



duce light, as opposed to the incandescent or CFL which are about 20% or up to 50% efficient, respectively.

We highly recommend you to switch all your existing light bulbs now with the available options of Eveready, Philips and Wipro. And if you're feeling a little adventurous, you can even go for something like the Phillips Hue LED bulbs and Cube26 Iota Lite 26, as it retails at a slightly lower price than the Philips Hue, claiming to be India's first LED bulb. Both offer LED bulbs that connect via Bluetooth and have a customisable colour palette all controlled by a smartphone app. Also, check out I-Switch,

a cheap light automation switch available for just ₹900 (<http://dgit.in/autooncfl>). Getting your conventional bulbs and CFLs to act 'smart' is what this product does. Hook up one of your CFLs to this I-Switch and it becomes one smart bulb which lights on and off using an in-built motion sensor and a passive infrared sensor which senses a human presence in the room. A great way to optimise your electricity usage.

HARVEST FREE SOLAR ENERGY

Due to India's position near the equator, we are blessed (or cursed?) with a lot of sunlight throughout the year, and with reduced / fluctuating monsoon, that spell has only increased in recent years. Solar power is an expensive substitute for one's day-to-day energy needs – meaning it requires a sizable initial investment to begin with – rooftop deployments for offices and large housing colonies are reporting enhanced savings from electricity bills. So yeah, it's a bit of a chicken and egg problem this, you won't see savings immediately with respect to your initial investment in solar panels atop your home or office building, but with time you will recover that investment from savings made on your monthly electricity bill. That has to appeal to everyone's kanjoos side, surely now? As to what are some of the key questions you need to ask before taking the solar plunge, read this nice little primer we found online – <http://dgit.in/SolarPowInstll>.

For other things, try to have a solar power alternative. For example, if you're going to buy a brand new powerbank, see if you can buy one that has a solar panel